SHIFTWELL · PRODUCT CASE SUBMISSION

Q4 2026 Product Recommendation

Memo to CEO · Reply to Sales · Assumptions · Build note · Prototype link · Supporting analysis

DELIVERABLE 1 · RECOMMENDATION MEMO

Build one swap-rules engine this quarter; defer WhatsApp and the custom overtime build

To: CEO · **From:** Product · **17 Oct 2026** · **Decision needed:** approve the sequence below. Engineering validates one estimate next week.

Recommendation

- **Build:** credential gate (S1), rules engine with auto-approval (S2–3), hours-cap rule with approver (S4), rollout (S5), buffer (S6).
- **Do not build:** WhatsApp approvals, a custom UrbanMart branch, a full credential suite.
- **Why:** the three requests are the same check on a shift assignment. Slow manual approval is what separates our weak accounts from our healthy ones. The two accounts we can still save by renewal (CarePoint, FreshBowl) and our largest (UrbanMart) are ₹254L, 62% of ARR.

1 The three requests share one cause: manual, slow, unchecked approval

Account	Asked for	Job to be done	Evidence
FreshBowl ₹84L · Jan 27 **At risk**	Swaps requested and approved on WhatsApp	A decision in minutes, with the same checks	38% approved in 24 h. Staff agree a swap on WhatsApp in 10 minutes, then wait a day; half skip the app. The manager approves "almost all", checking only training and overtime.
CarePoint ₹60L · Dec 26 **At risk**	Block expired certificates	Same: an automatic control, not a manager's Excel	Audit found two shifts covered by lapsed BLS; one more finding means a penalty. Ask and need match.
UrbanMart ₹110L · Aug 27 **Healthy**	Regional approval above 48 h	Overtime control (9% of wage bill) without more approvals	Already 36% of swaps wait over a day. A blanket approval step adds load; escalate exceptions only.

The churn sits in shift-heavy accounts, and approval speed is the symptom. The four restaurant, cafe and gym accounts hold ₹160L (39% of ARR). All are at risk or on watch, with 29–41% approved in 24 h and managers spending 5.5–7 h a week on scheduling against 2.5–4 h elsewhere. Two of the four accounts we lost (₹41L, half of ₹80L) were restaurants. In total ₹220L, 54% of ARR, is at risk or on watch and renews by March 2027 (Fig. 1).

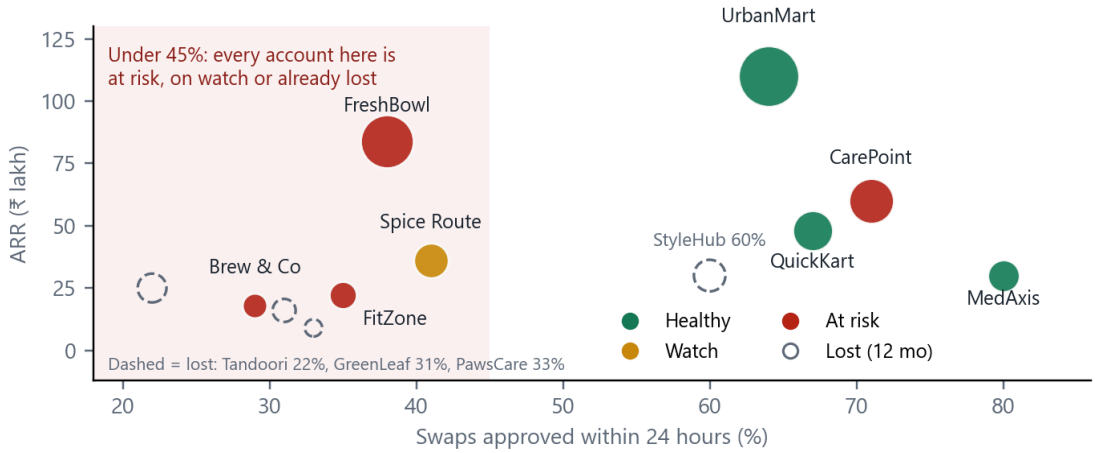


Fig. 1. Approval speed vs account status; bubble = ARR. Directional, not causal: 12 accounts, and restaurants are structurally swap-heavy.

It is not WhatsApp. Only GreenLeaf (₹16L of ₹80L lost) left for a WhatsApp competitor, and its former head of operations says managers couldn't keep up and RotaPro auto-approved trained staff. Three of four lost accounts were at 22–33% on 24-hour approvals.

Approval is a rubber stamp that costs a day, not a manager-hours problem. A typical FreshBowl location sees about 24 swaps a month: 2–4 hours of approvals against about 28 hours of scheduling. The "25–30 a night" quote is 34 times the chain average, so I treat it as an outlier. Auto-approval buys speed and safety; building the roster is the bigger manager burden, a candidate for next quarter.

2 Options considered: only the engine meets all three asks and keeps a buffer

Option	Sprints	Fixes approval delay	All 3 asks	Verdict
A. Build as asked: WhatsApp, UrbanMart custom, certificates	6	○ Same approval, new screen	●	**No: no buffer, three code paths**
B. Hard-code certificates, overtime, a simple auto-approve*	5	◐ FreshBowl only	●	**No: each new ask costs a sprint**
C. Rules engine: credential, hours, training as settings	4 + 1	● Auto-approve eligible	●	**Recommended: keeps a buffer**
D. Certificate gate only, wait for estimates	1	○	○	**No: FreshBowl, UrbanMart wait**

*Auto-approve unestimated; I assume 2 sprints. Alongside C, Customer Success calls FitZone and Brew & Co, which renew before anything ships.

3 Plan: each release lands before the renewal it protects

Sprint	Ships	For	Exit check
S1	**Credential gate.** Required credentials per role, with expiry, checked against the shift date. Blocks scheduling; swaps into an expired certificate cannot be approved. Expiry alerts. Admin-only override, logged.	CarePoint	Live early Nov. Warn-only for 14 days, then enforced. CS loads their Excel.
S2–3	**Rules engine.** Credential and training checks, auto-approval, exception queue, decision log, eligibility shown to staff.	FreshBowl pilot (5–10 stores)	≥85% decided in 24 h (38% today). Hypothesis: about 80% auto-approved.
S4	**Hours-cap rule** with a designated approver, as a setting.	UrbanMart	Live by 11 Dec.
S5–6	Rollout, hardening, manager training. S6 is buffer, then the WhatsApp decision on pilot data.	All	No valid staff wrongly blocked.

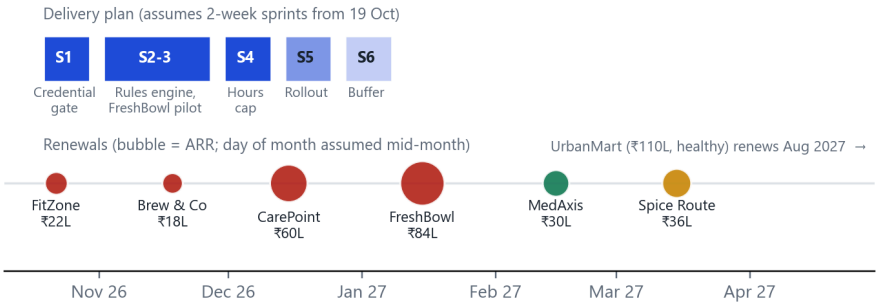


Fig. 2. Delivery plan (2-week sprints from 19 Oct) against renewals. S5 ends 25 Dec; if the quarter closes 31 Dec, the buffer is what we lose.

The engine estimate is mine, not Engineering's: about 2 sprints (range 1.5 to 3), plus about 1 for the hours rule. At 3 the plan fits with no buffer; beyond that the hours rule ships as manager escalation.

Not building

- **WhatsApp approvals (3 sprints).** Half of capacity to relocate the same approval. Message cost is small (about ₹0.5L a year for FreshBowl); the sprints are the cost. If FreshBowl makes it a renewal condition, a notification-only version on the engine comes next.
- **A custom UrbanMart build (2 sprints).** Single-customer code at about twice the cost of the same rule as a setting.
- **A credential suite** (uploads, verification) or a regional hierarchy. One "approver" designation only.

What we tell each account

CarePoint	Credential block ships first, early November, for BLS and council registration. Send your credential list and name one Admin owner. This week, Customer Success runs an expiry check against your sheet.
FreshBowl	Swaps that pass training and overtime checks are approved instantly; the rest reach the manager. Pilot from late November in stores you choose. WhatsApp is reviewed after the pilot, with real numbers.
UrbanMart	The 48-hour rule arrives as a setting, targeted 11 December once Engineering confirms. Please help define the week boundary and your approvers.
FitZone, Brew & Co	Renewals come first. Customer Success calls this week with a place in the pilot. Any commercial offer is your call.

Measures North star: % of swaps decided in 24 h. Drivers: share auto-approved. Guardrails: valid staff wrongly blocked, overrides, wrong approvals. Outcome: renewals, overtime share of wage bill. **Risks** FreshBowl renews on a WhatsApp checklist; bad credential data blocks valid staff; the engine runs past 3 sprints. Mitigations are in the supporting analysis (A4).

Reply to the sales head

Deliverable 2 · 174 words

Thanks for the memo. The stakes are real: UrbanMart is 27% of ARR and RotaPro is a credible competitor.

The data points elsewhere. GreenLeaf's former head of operations told us it wasn't WhatsApp: managers couldn't keep up with approvals, and RotaPro auto-approved trained staff. Three of the four accounts we lost were at 22–33% on 24-hour approvals; our four weakest today sit at 29–41%. WhatsApp costs three of our six sprints and leaves that unchanged.

So we build one rules engine. UrbanMart's 48-hour rule becomes a setting, not a custom build, targeted for 11 December with half the effort. That is a delivery this quarter, not a no.

Certificates aren't only a clinic issue. CarePoint's ₹60L renews in December after an audit finding, and the gate is one sprint. Diagnostics and gyms likely need it too.

Two asks. Find out what UrbanMart's VP means by "look at options", since it isn't in our notes, and who their regional approvers are. And join me on the FreshBowl call: auto-approval first, WhatsApp reviewed after the pilot.

Assumptions

Deliverable 3 · every assumption made where the data pack was silent

- **Capacity and calendar.** Six sprints is the team's total, including testing. Sprints are two weeks from 19 Oct, so S5 ends 25 Dec and S6 (buffer) ends 8 Jan. Renewal dates are given as months; I plot them mid-month.
- **Engine estimate.** About 2 sprints (range 1.5 to 3); the hours-cap rule about 1 on top. Mine, to be validated by the engineering lead.
- **S1 scope.** The given 1 sprint covers the credential field and the scheduling block. Blocking swaps at approval, expiry alerts and a basic override log are assumed to fit; if not, they move into S2. Automatic swap blocking arrives with the engine.
- **Credential data.** Customer Success loads CarePoint's expiry dates from their Excel; no import screen in v1. After 14 days warn-only, a missing required credential blocks. Unknown training goes to the manager.
- **Hours rule.** Week is Monday to Sunday, scheduled hours, leave excluded. v1 covers swaps and extra shifts; roster building shows a warning. Approval at roster publish is a stretch item, so UrbanMart's literal "any shift" ask is partly staged.
- **Regional approver.** No such role exists. I assume one "approver" designation set by Admin, built in S4.
- **Auto-approval.** About 80% of FreshBowl swaps are eligible (the manager "approves almost all"). The 85% target is a hypothesis that exceptions keep today's pace.
- **Volumes.** "25–30 a night" is 34 times the chain average of 24 per location per month, so treated as an outlier. At average volume, approvals take about 2–4 h a month at 5–10 minutes each. The benefit is speed and safety, not manager hours.
- **Off-app swaps.** The line cook says half. Recorded counts therefore understate demand; I have not sized it.
- **WhatsApp cost.** Four messages per swap at ₹0.35 is about ₹4,000 a month (₹0.5L a year) for FreshBowl.
- **Causality.** Health labels and approval rates are as given. Twelve accounts show a pattern, not proof.
- **Certificates beyond clinics** (diagnostics, gyms, some restaurant roles) are an inference. Clinics and diagnostics are ₹90L, 22% of ARR on 10% of locations.
- **Churn evidence.** Sales-recorded reasons are unverified; only GreenLeaf has a first-hand exit call. "Look at options" comes from the sales memo only. No customer was contacted.
- **Churn base.** Opening ARR is ₹408L plus ₹80L lost, so about 16% gross churn, ignoring new logos.

Build note

Deliverable 4 · 176 words

The prototype is a single-file web app with no backend. It shows the new experience for four roles: staff and location manager on mobile, a regional approver, and Admin on the web. Pick FreshBowl, CarePoint or UrbanMart and follow a guided walkthrough: staff see who can take a shift before asking, the rules engine decides, and the right person is told. Managers see only exceptions. Admin edits rules, previews the effect on past requests, publishes, and overrides blocks with a logged reason. A release switch shows the product as of Sprint 1, 2–3 and 4+. A handoff tab holds the decision table, data model and open questions.

AI: several tools, including ChatGPT and Claude, were used to cross-check the analysis, logic and code, alongside my own thinking and drafting. Chat links can't be shared; I'm happy to walk through the process.

A real version needs: a per-role credential model with expiry; versioned rules; weekly-hours logic (week boundary, leave, both sides of a swap); approver routing; decision and audit log; notifications; warn-only mode; feature flags and tests.

Links

Deliverables 5 and 6

Working prototype	https://hanvithsai.github.io/Shiftwell/
Source and case files	https://github.com/hanvithSai/Shiftwell
AI chat link	Not shareable. Multiple AI tools were used for cross-validation; available to walk through in the interview.

APPENDIX

Supporting analysis

The evidence behind the diagnosis, the sequence and the risks.

A1 · Why is ₹220L at risk by March 2027? Four causes tested

Hypothesis	If true, we would see	What the data shows	Verdict
H1 Competitor feature gap (WhatsApp)	Lost accounts cite it; at-risk accounts ask for it	One of four losses (₹16L of ₹80L). GreenLeaf's exit call says it was approvals. Only FreshBowl's Ops Director asks.	**Weak cause; real renewal risk**
H2 Price or budget	Losses unrelated to usage quality	StyleHub (₹30L) and TandooriTown (₹25L) recorded by Sales, unverified. Tandoori sat at 22% approvals, the lowest, which looks like low perceived value.	**Partial**
H3 Value not delivered: slow manual approval	Low 24-hour approval wherever accounts are weak; heavy manager time	All four current accounts under 45% are at risk or watch. Three of four losses at 22–33%. Managers spend 5.5–7 h a week vs 2.5–4 h.	**Supported**
H4 Compliance gap in regulated roles	Audit findings; regulated segments churning	CarePoint audit finding on record. PawsCare returned to spreadsheets. Clinics and diagnostics are 22% of ARR.	**Supported, narrow**

A2 · What each role is trying to get done

Who	Job to be done	What they asked	Kind of need
CarePoint compliance head	When an auditor checks, I want proof that no unqualified person worked, so we avoid a penalty.	Block expired certificates	**Must-be.** Absence costs a penalty; presence earns no delight.
FreshBowl staff and manager	When I can't work a shift, I want it covered by someone qualified and settled fast, without chasing anyone.	WhatsApp approvals	**Performance.** Faster is better, on any channel.
FreshBowl Ops Director	When we renew, I want to be sure we are not behind the competition.	WhatsApp	**Parity.** Expected because RotaPro has it.
UrbanMart VP HR	When hours pass 48, I want to control cost without slowing the floor.	Approval above 48 h	**Performance.** Fewer overtime hours is better.

A3 · Prioritisation: score, then sequence by renewal date

Candidate	Reach (ARR ₹L)	Confidence	Effort (sprints)	Score	Renewal pressure	Basis for confidence
Certificate gate	60	80%	1	**48**	Dec 2026	Audit finding on record; estimate given
Rules engine core	160	60%	2*	**48**	Jan–Mar 2027	Pattern in four accounts, GreenLeaf exit, "approves almost all" quote
Hours-cap rule on engine	110	50%	1*	**55**	Aug 2027	VP quote; the "look at options" threat is unverified
UrbanMart custom overtime	110	50%	2	**28**	Aug 2027	Same demand, but single-customer code
WhatsApp approvals	84	30%	3	**8**	Jan 2027	Contradicted by GreenLeaf; solves channel, not delay

Score = Reach × Confidence ÷ Effort. Reach is ARR addressed, a proxy for value. Confidence and the starred efforts are my judgment (assumptions list). **Pure scoring would put the hours rule first. I did not:** it needs the engine, and its renewal is ten months away. Sequencing by cost of delay and dependency gives CarePoint (December), then the engine (FreshBowl in January), then the hours rule. The sales plan's biggest item, WhatsApp, scores lowest.

A4 · If this fails by February 2027, why?

Cause	Impact	Mitigation built into the plan
FreshBowl did not renew: the Ops Director judged us on a WhatsApp checklist.	₹84L	Pilot numbers in his hands by mid-December. S6 is a decision gate for a notification-only WhatsApp version, if he makes it a condition.
The credential gate blocked valid staff, or left a clinic unstaffed.	₹60L	14 days warn-only while data is loaded. Admin-only override with a logged reason.
The engine ran past three sprints.	Pilot slips	Estimate checked with the lead next week. Fallback: ship the hours rule as manager escalation. S6 is buffer.
Auto-approval approved something it should not have.	Trust	Every decision logged with its reason. Unknown training goes to a person. Weekly sample review in the pilot.

A5 · How we will measure it, and what comes after

Level	Metric	Target or trigger
North star	% of swaps decided within 24 hours	FreshBowl 38% today. Pilot hypothesis ≥85%.
Drivers	Share auto-approved; time in the exception queue	Hypothesis: about 80% auto-approved.
Guardrails	Valid staff wrongly blocked; overrides; wrong auto-approvals reported	Zero wrongly blocked after warn-only.
Outcome	Expired-credential shifts worked; overtime share of wage bill; renewals of at-risk ARR	Zero audit findings. Baselines first, then targets.

Horizon	Scope	Revisit trigger
Now	Credential gate, rules engine, hours-cap rule, rollout (S1–S5)	Plan as above.
Next	WhatsApp notifications for exceptions. Roster templates and auto-fill.	FreshBowl makes WhatsApp a renewal condition, or pilot queue times stay high. Manager scheduling time stays above 5 h a week in shift-heavy accounts.
Later	Credential document upload and verification. Multi-level approval hierarchy.	Demand from more than one account.